MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, CALIBER .50, TRACER, PLASTIC PRACTICE: M860

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers quality assurance provisions and preparation for delivery for Cartridge, Caliber .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice: M860

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATION

MILITARY

MIL-A-48078	-	Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification For.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Table For Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-636	-	Visual Standards for Small Arms Ammunition Through Caliber .50.
MIL-STD-644	-	Visual Inspection Standards and Inspection Procedures for Inspection of Packaging, Packing and Marking of Small Arms Ammunition.

FSC 1305

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Center, Attn. DRSMC-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

DRAWINGS (See 6.4)

US ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CENTER

PRODUCT AND PACKING DRAWINGS

7643674	-	Classification of Cartridge Case Defects Small Arms Ammunition
9340558	-	Cartridge, M860, Cal .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice
9345009	-	Combination of Adopted Items (Cal .50, M858, M860, and M9 Link)
9345164	-	Combination of Adopted Items (Cal .50, Tracer, M860, and M9 Link)

INSPECTION EQUIPMENT DRAWINGS

LI-9340558	-	Index of Inspection Equipment Lists for: Cartridge, M860, Cal .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice

PUBLICATIONS (See 6.4)

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

SCATP-5.56	-	Ammunition Ballistic Acceptance Test Methods, Test Procedures for 5.56MM Cartridges
TECP 700-700, Vol. III	-	Manual of Test Methods for Small Arms Ammunition

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, and publication required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.1.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings, specifications and standards.

3.2 Parts. All parts shall comply with applicable drawings, specifications and standards.

3.3 Cartridge. The cartridge shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (Dwg.) 9340558, all associated drawings, and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications and standards.

3.4 Bullet pull. The force required to separate the bullet from the cartridge case shall be not less than 160 pounds when tested as specified in 4.5.1.

3.5 Head pull. The force requiredto separate the head from the cartridge case shall be not less than 400 pounds when tested as specified in 4.5.2.

3.6 Residual stress. The cartridge shall not split or crack when subjected to an aqueous Antorox CO-630 solution, or equivalent, for not less than 6 hours when tested as specified in 4.5.3.

3.7 Waterproof. After submergence in water, the average velocity of the sample cartridges shall not vary from the average velocity obtained in the velocity test for the same lot by more than 100 ft./sec. when tested as specified in 4.5.4.

3.8 Action time. The action time (overall primer ignition, propellant burning and bullet-in-barrel time) of the cartridge, conditioned at 70°F ± 2°F (21°C ± 1°C), shall not exceed 4 milliseconds when tested as specified in 4.5.5.

3.9 Velocity. The average velocity of the sample cartridges, conditioned at 70°F ± 2°F, shall be 2750 feet per sec (fps) plus or minus 50 fps at 78 feet from the muzzle. The standard deviation of the velocities shall not eceed 65.6 fps when tested as specified in 4.5.6

3.10 Chamber pressure. The average chamber pressure of the sample cartridge, conditioned at 70°F ± 2°F (21°C ± 1°C), shall not exceed 26,100 psi (1800 bars). Neither the chamber pressure of an individual sample cartridge nor the average chamber pressure plus three standard deviations of chamber pressure shall exceed 29,010 psi (2000 bars) when tested as specified in 4.5.7.

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3.11 Trace. When viewed at night from a line parallel to the plane of the trajectory, with the sight perpendicular to the plane of trajectory at each point of observation, the bullet of the tracer cartridge shall exhibit a visible trace of full luminosity from a point not greater than 20 meters from the muzzle to a point not less than 150 meters from the muzzle when tested as specified in 4.5.8.

3.12 Accuracy. The average of the mean radii of all targets of the sample cartridges, when fired at a range of 109 yards (100 meters) shall not exceed 4.7 inches and when fired at 600 yards shall not exceed 12 inches. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.5.9.

3.13 Function and casualty. The cartridge shall cause the M2 machine gun with a recoil amplifier to function without casualty at a rate of fire of 450-600 rounds per minute, at temperatures of +70°F (+21°C), -4°F (-20°C) and +104°F (+40°C) when tested as specified in 4.5.10.

3.14 First article inspection. This specification contains technical provisions for first article inspection. Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract (see 4.3).

3.15 Workmanship. All plastic components shall be fabricated in a thorough, workmanlike manner and shall be free of porosity, twist, warpage, heat marks, sinks, voids, checks, cracks, chipped edges, burrs, bubbles, blisters, scratches, excess flash, and other defects which would affect their serviceability. All metal parts shall be fabricated in a thorough, workmanlike manner. They shall be free of burrs, chips, chipped edges, gouges, cracks, splits, surface defects, dust, dirt, grease, oil, and other foreign matter. All assemblies shall be assembled in a thorough, and workmanlike manner.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection and standard quality assurance provisions. Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this detail specification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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4.3 First article inspection.

4.3.1 Submission. The contractor shall submit a first article sample as designated by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.3.2. The first article sample shall consist of the following items in sample quantities as indicated below:

Part Description	Drawings	Quantity
Cartrige, M860, Cal .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice	9340558	3575

4.3.2 Inspections to be performed. See MIL-A-48078 and Table II specified herein.

4.3.3 Rejection. See MIL-A-48078 and Tables I and II.

4.3.3.1 Function and casualty. The sample shall be rejected if any defect exceeds the acceptance number specified in Table I.

TABLE I

	DEFECT	ACCEPTANCE NUMBER	REJECTION NUMBER
1.	Misfire	1	2
2.	Weapon Stoppages Attributable To Ammunition 1/	0	1
3.	Bullet in bore	0	-
4.	Separation of Case Base From from Plastic Body	0	1
5.	Failure to Extract	0	1
6.	Primer Defects:		
	a. Perforation in firing pin indent in primer cup	24	25
	b. Escape of gas through primer cup other than 6a	7	8

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c. Escape of gas around primer cup more than 50% of periphery	14	15
d. Blown primer or primer that falls out of pocket on retraction of bolt	0	1
7. Case Casualties: 2/		
a. Longitudinal Split		
1. Body (K) extending to case base	8	9
2. Case base (L)	0	1
3. Through case base (M)	0	1
b. Circumferential rupture		
1. Partial, neck, shoulder, or body (S, J, or K)	1	2
2. Partial, case base (L)	0	1
3. Complete	0	1

1/ Occasionally, the last round of a continuous belt, due to the light weight of the cartridge case, will not fully eject from the weapon. Failure to eject shall not be classified as a weapon stoppage nor shall it be recorded as a defect chargeable to the ammunition. All other stoppages attributable to the ammunition, with the exception of misfire, failure to extract and complete circumferential rupture shall be included in this defect category.

2/ For location of defects, indicated in parentheses, see Dwg. 7643674.

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TABLE II. First Article Inspection.

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-64038 (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET 1 OF 1	DRAWING NUMBER
	Cartridge, M860, Cal .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice		9340558
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Examination for Defects	200	Acc 0 Rej 1	3.3, 3.15	4.4.2.1
	Bullet pull	50	Acc 0 Rej 1	3.4	4.5.1
	Head pull	50	Acc 0 Rej 1	3.5	4.5.2
	Residual stress	50	Acc 0 Rej 1	3.6	4.5.3
	Waterproof	50	1/	3.7	4.5.4
	Action time 2/	50	Acc 0 Rej 1	3.8	4.5.5
	Velocity 2	50	1/	3.9	4.5.6
	Chamber pressure 2/	50	1/	3.10	4.5.7
	Trace	125	Acc 10 Rej 11	3.11	4.5.8
	Accuracy	300 3/	1/	3.12	4.5.9
	Function and casualty at ambient temperature	900	Table 1	3.13	4.5.10
	Function and casualty at cold temperature	900	Table 1	3.13	4.5.10
	Function and casualty at hot temperature	900	Table 1	3.13	4.5.10

NOTES: 1/ The sample shall be rejected if it does not comply with the applicable requirement.
2/ These tests shall be performed conncurrently.
3/ One half of the sample shall be tested at 100 meters and the other half at 600 yards.

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Inspection lot formation. Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078. In addition, each lot shall contain:

a. Case heads of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.
b. Case and projectile bodies of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.
c. Primers of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.
d. Propellant from one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

4.4.1.1 Cavity identification. The contractor shall maintain an approved cavity identification system. Cartridges shall be grouped and identified until all inspections have been completed.

4.4.2 Examination. See MIL-A-48078.

a. Sampling plans. Unless otherwise specified in the classification of Defects and Test Tables, sampling plans and procedures for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level II.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-64038 (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Cartridge: M860, Caliber .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice	1 OF 3	9340558
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical					
1.	Primer missing		100%	3.3	Visual
Major					
101.	Primer above flush or below maximum depth		.40	3.3	Gage
102.	Total length, maximum		.40	3.3	Gage
103.	Diameter of extractor groove, maximum		.40	3.3	Gage
104.	Diameter of head, maximum		.40	3.3	Gage
105.	Thickness of head, maximum		.40	3.3	Gage
106.	Cocked primer 1/		.40	3.3	Visual
107.	Inverted primer 1/		.40	3.3	Visual
108.	Loose primer 1/		.40	3.3	Visual/Manual
109.	Split case 1/		.40	3.3	Visual
110.	Perforated case 1/		.40	3.3	Visual
111.	Primer crimp missing, incomplete, or improper		.40%	3.3	Visual
112.	Profile and alignment		.40%	3.3	Gage

NOTES: 1/ Refer to MIL-STD-636 for visual defects. While no photographs of practice cartridges are included in this standard, the cartridge case defects and primer defects illustrated in the caliber .50 section can be used. In the event of conflict between paragraphs of this specification MIL-STD-636 as to defect classification, the classification specified in this specification shall apply.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Cartridge: M860, Caliber .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice	2 OF 3	9340558
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS 2/	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
113.	Bullet pull	32/32	1.0%	3.4	4.5.1
114.	Head pull	32/32	1.0%	3.5	4.5.2
115.	Residual stress	32/32	1.0%	3.6	4.5.3
116.	Waterproofness	20/40	3/	3.7	4.5.4
117.	Action time 4/	32/32	1.0%	3.8	4.5.5
118.	Velocity 4/	20/40	3/	3.9	4.5.6
119.	Chamber pressure 4/	20/40	3/	3.10	4.5.7
120.	Accuracy 5/	90/180	3/	3.12	4.5.8
121.	Trace	80/160	6.5%	3.11	4.5.9
122.	Function and casualty at ambient temperature	300/600	Table III	3.13	4.5.10

NOTES: 2/ When two numbers appear in this column, a double sampling plan applies. The second number indicates the size of the second sample. Only one retest using the sample size specified shall be permitted.
3/ The sample shall be rejected if it does not comply with the applicable requirement.
4/ These tests shall be performed concurrently.
5/ The sample shall only be tested at 100 meters.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Cartridge: M860, Caliber .50, Tracer, Plastic Practice	3 OF 3	9340558
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
123.	Function and casualty at cold temperature	300/ 600	Table III	3.13	4.5.10
124.	Function and casualty at hot temperature	300/ 600	Table III	3.13	4.5.10
Minor					
201.	Presence of dirt or oil		0.65	3.3	Visual
202.	Chamfer missing from case base		0.65	3.3	Visual
203.	Marking on face of case base illegible or missing 1/		0.65	3.3	Visual
204.	Defective head 1/		0.65	3.3	Visual
205.	Nicked or dented head 1/		0.65	3.3	Visual
206.	Poor workmanship		1.0	3.15	Visual

NOTES:

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4.4.3 Function and casualty. Firing defects and acceptance and rejection numbers shall be as specified in Table III.

TABLE III

DEFECT	ACCEPTANCE NUMBERS 1/ FIRST SAMPLE	CUMULATIVE (first & second sample)
1. Misfire	1	2
2. Weapon Stoppages Attributable To Ammunition 2/	0	1
3. Bullet in bore	0	-
4. Separation of Case Base From from Plastic Body	0	1
5. Failure to Extract	0	1
6. Primer Defects:		
a. Perforation in firing pin indent in primer cup	18	45
b. Escape of gas through primer cup other than 6a	6	13
c. Escape of gas around primer cup more than 50% of periphery	12	25
d. Blown primer or primer that falls out of pocket on retraction of bolt	0	1
7. Case Casualties: 3/		
a. Longitudinal Split		
1. Body (K) extending to case base	7	15
2. Case base (L)	0	1
3. Through case base (M)	0	1
b. Circumferential rupture		
1. Partial, neck, shoulder, or body (S, J, or K)	2	4
2. Partial, case base (L)	0	1
3. Complete	0	1

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1/ The lot shall be rejected when function and casualty defects plus firing defects observed in all other firing tests exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample in Table III. If the number of defects found in the first test exceeds the acceptance number for the first sample, but is equal to or less than the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, a second sample, consisting of double the quantities specified under the function and casualty test, shall be fired. If the total number of defects in the combined first and second sample exceeds the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected. If, in testing a second sample, defects other than those for which the second sample is being tested should occur to the extent that they exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected.

2/ Occasionally, the last round of a continuous belt, due to the light weight of the cartridge case, will not fully eject from the weapon. Failure to eject shall not be classified as a weapon stoppage nor shall it be recorded a defect chargeable to the ammunition. All other stoppages attributable to the ammunition, with the exception of misfire, failure to extract and complete circumferential rupture shall be included in this defect category.

3/ For location of defects, indicated in parentheses, see Dwg. 7643674.

4.4.4 Packaging, packing, and marking. Inspection for packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-644 and Dwgs. 9345009 and 9345164.

4.4.5 Inspection equipment. The inspection equipment required to perform the inspections and tests prescribed herein is described in the Index of InspectionEquipment List LI-9340558 and the Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method column in the tables starting with paragraph 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078, and 6.2 herein.

4.5 Test methods and procedures.

4.5.1 Bullet pull. The cartridges shall be tested in a government approved bullet pull machine. The rate of travel of the test head shall be not less than three nor more than six inches per minute.

4.5.2 Head pull. The cartridges shall be tested in a government approved head pull machine. The rate of travel of the test head shall be not less than three nor more than six inches per minute.

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4.5.3 Residual stress. The test shall be conducted in accordance with TECP 700-700, Vol. III. An aqueous solution of Antorox CD-630 shall be used in place of mercurous nitrate.

4.5.4 Waterproof. The test shall be conducted in accordance with TECP 700-700, Vol. III.

4.5.5 Action time. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56MM using methods and equipment in accordance with 4.4.4.

4.5.6 Velocity. The test shall be conducted in accordance with TECP 700-700, Vol. III.

4.5.7 Chamber pressure. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56 MM, Chapter 1, Section 18. A piezoelectric transducer shall be used for pressure measurement.

4.5.8 Trace. The test shall be conducted in accordance with methods and procedures of TECP 700-700, Vol. III and the following.

All trace testing shall be performed at night. Observation for trace performance shall be made at the weapon and at points 20 meters and 150 meters beyond the muzzle of the gun on a line parallel to and approximately 75 yards from the plane of trajectory. Lights or other suitable visible markers shall be placed opposite the 20 and 150 meters observing points to insure a line of sight from each point perpendicular to the plane of the trajectory. The ammunition shall not be conditioned to temperature but shall be fired under ambient conditions. Three cartridges shall be fired to sight, warm and foul each weapon prior to the test. The sample cartridges shall be fired in regular sequence permitting sufficient time between shots for each observer to record trace characteristics at each observation point. Each cartridge shall be considered as a defective once only in the event it fails at more than one observation point. During the performance of this test, observation shall also be made for (a) bullet bursting before striking terminal or target; (b) trace muzzle flash and (c) erratic flight.

4.5.9 Accuracy. The test shall be conducted in accordance with TECP 700-700, Vol. III, using Gun, Machine, Caliber .50, Browning, M2 with recoil amplifier barrel assembly.

4.5.10 Function and casualty. The test shall be conducted in accordance with TECP 700-700, Vol. III, and the following:

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Using Machine, Gun, Cal .50: M2, Heavy Barrel, Flexible with recoil amplifier barrel assembly, fire a 100-round continuous burst followed by 10 bursts of approximately 20-rounds each until a total of 300 rounds have been fired. This sequence shall be repeated when required.

4.5.10.1 Function and casualty at ambient temperature. the test sample shall be stored at + 70°F ± 2° for not less than two hours and shall be fired at that temperature.

4.5.10.2 Function and casualty at cold temperature. The test sample shall be stored at - 4°F ± 2° for not less than six hours and shall be fired at that temperature.

4.5.10.3 Function and casualty at hot temperature. The test sample shall be stored 104°F ± 2° for not less than four hours and shall be fired at that temperature.

4.5.11 Defect penalty. In any ballistic test except function and casualty, in which the occurrence of a firing defect listed in Table I or III prevents the obtaining of a reliable result for the characteristic being tested, an additional shot shall be fired. That particular test shall not be penalized, but the total ballistic sample shall be penalized for such defects in accordance with Table I or III.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation - packing.

5.1.1 Level A. The cartridges shall be packed in accordance with Dwgs. 9345009 and 9345164.

5.2 Marking and labeling. Packing boxes shall be marked and labeled in accordance with Dwgs. cited in 5.1.1.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. See MIL-A-48078.

6.2 Submission of inspection equipment designs for approval. (See MIL-A-48078). Equipment designs shall be submitted as required to: Commander, U.S. Army Armament Research and Development Center, ATTN: DRSMC-QAF-I(D), Dover, NJ 07801. Request letter of submittal should state contractor, contract number, specification number, item nomenclature, and classification of defects and tests paragraph number.

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6.3 Data cards. (See MIL-A-48078). Distribution of data cards shall include the following: Commander, U.S. Army Armament Research and Development Center, ATTN: DRSMC-QAF-S(D), Dover, NJ 07801.

6.4 Documents. Documents listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research and Development Center (ARDC) may also include documents prepared by, and identified as, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal or Picatinny Arsenal documents. Technical data originally prepared by these activities are now under the cognizance of ARDC.

6.5 Data submission. Results of all tests performed by the contractor shall be submitted in accordance with Data Item DI-R-1721 on the DD Form 1423 for the contract. Distribution shall include the address specified in 6.3.

6.6 Data items. Data required by this specification are cited in the paragraphs listed below. The Form DD 1423 should include distribution of data cards as specified in 6.3.

Paragraph	Data requirement	Applicable DID
4.5	Quality Inspection Defect Report	DI-R-1721

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing activity:
Army-AR

(Project 1305-A917)

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

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DOVER, NJ 07801

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-64038 (AR)	CARTRIDGE, CALIBER .50, TRACER, PLASTIC PRACTICE: M60

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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